

TEACHING TIPS:

- This song is guaranteed to bring a smile and **a sense of joy** to both singers and audience! It needs to be sung with loads of energy and bounce.
- Point out the **variation to the melody** on 'free as a bird' in the chorus, and enjoy how this is different to the melody of 'we're tickety-boo'.
- Notice that on the penultimate chorus, the last line 'We're full of the joys of spring!' is only sung once.

WHAT YOU NEED

Xylophones, glockenspiels or keyboards

Notation

Improvise

Sing

Listen

Play

Compose

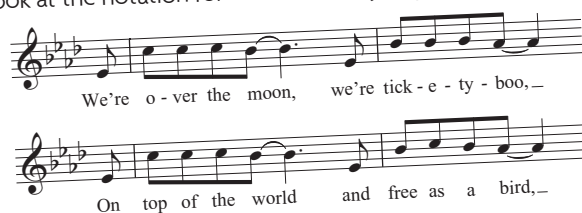
Genre/History/Musicians

ACTIVITY

AGES 7-11 

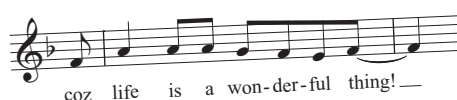
Musical variations

Look at the notation for the chorus as you play the vocal track:



Show the children how the 'free as a bird' melody has been altered or 'varied' from its first appearance on 'we're tickety-boo'. This comes as a bit of a surprise and so makes your ears prick up!

Now give out xylophones, glockenspiels or keyboards. Can they play the 'coz life is a wonderful thing' line? (Transposed into F major for ease.)



Now see if the children can **create their own variation** by changing one or more of the notes of the melody. Ask for volunteers to demonstrate their version to the class.

LISTEN

Explain that composers often write a **theme and variations**, where the main melody, harmony or instrumentation is altered to create interest. Listen to some extracts from famous classical themes and variations, e.g.

The Young Person's Guide To The Orchestra –

Benjamin Britten

12 Variations on 'Ah, vous dirai-je, Maman'

(also known as 'Twinkle, Twinkle, Little

Star') – W. A. Mozart

WHAT'S ACHIEVABLE?

- To recognize a melodic variation.
- To listen to themes and variations.
- To improvise a melodic variation.

PITCH

How high or low a note sits

STRUCTURE

The organization of a piece of music into sections, e.g. ABA or verse and chorus

NOTATION

A system of written symbols used to visually represent aurally perceived music